

HTML Cheat Sheet

The tags that give a web page its structure — text, links, media, lists, tables and forms, all in one quick reference.

SECTIONS

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HTML (HyperText Markup Language) describes *what* content is — a heading, a paragraph, a button. Keep this sheet beside you while you build; every element here is one you'll reach for often.

HTML Cheat Sheet

An HTML element is written as an **opening tag**, some content, and a **closing tag**: `<p>Hello</p>`. A few elements are *empty* and have no closing tag, like `<img>` and `<br>`.

The document skeleton

Every HTML file starts from the same boilerplate. In VS Code, typing `!` then `Tab` generates it for you.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport"
    content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Page Title</title>
</head>
<body>
  <!-- visible content goes here -->
</body>
</html>
```

HTML

Part	Why it's there
<code><!DOCTYPE html></code>	Tells the browser to use modern (HTML5) rules.
<code><html lang></code>	The root element; <code>lang</code> aids search engines & screen readers.
<code><head></code>	Info <i>about</i> the page — not shown on screen.
<code><meta charset></code>	Character encoding; <code>UTF-8</code> supports every language & emoji.
<code><meta viewport></code>	Makes the page scale correctly on phones.
<code><title></code>	The text shown on the browser tab.
<code><body></code>	Everything the visitor actually sees.

Headings & text

Tag	Use
<code><h1> ... <h6></code>	Six heading levels. Use one <code><h1></code> per page; don't skip levels.
<code><p></code>	A paragraph of text.
<code>
</code>	A line break inside text (empty tag).
<code><hr></code>	A thematic divider (horizontal rule).

Tag	Use
<code><blockquote></code>	A block of quoted text.
<code><pre></code>	Preformatted text — keeps spaces & line breaks.

Inline formatting

Tag	Meaning
<code></code>	Important — shown bold (semantic).
<code></code>	Emphasis — shown <i>italic</i> (semantic).
<code></code> / <code><i></code>	Bold / italic <i>look only</i> , no meaning. Prefer the two above.
<code><mark></code>	Highlighted text.
<code><small></code>	Fine print.
<code><sub></code> / <code><sup></code>	Subscript (H ₂ O) / superscript (x ²).
<code></code> / <code><ins></code>	Struck-out / inserted text.
<code><code></code>	A snippet of code, in a mono font.
<code></code>	A generic inline box for styling a piece of text.

TIP

Reach for the **meaning** first: `<strong>` and `<em>` tell browsers and screen readers the text matters, while `<b>` and `<i>` only change the look.

Links & images

```

<a href="https://example.com" target="_blank">Visit site</a>
<a href="about.html">About</a>           <!-- same folder -->
<a href="#section-2">Jump down the page</a>



```

HTML

Attribute	Meaning
<code>href</code>	The link's destination (URL, file, or <code>#id</code>).
<code>target="_blank"</code>	Open the link in a new tab.
<code>src</code>	The image file to load.

Attribute	Meaning
<code>alt</code>	Text shown if the image fails — and read aloud by screen readers.
<code>width</code> / <code>height</code>	Size in pixels (set one to keep the ratio).

NOTE

Always write meaningful `alt` text for images. It is essential for accessibility and helps SEO.

Lists

```

<ul>
  <li>Bread</li>
  <li>Milk</li>
</ul>

<ol>
  <li>Wake up</li>
  <li>Code</li>
</ol>

<dl>
  <dt>HTML</dt>
  <dd>Structure</dd>
</dl>

```

HTML

Tag	Meaning
<code></code>	Unordered list — bullets.
<code></code>	Ordered list — numbers.
<code></code>	A list item (inside <code></code> or <code></code>).
<code><dl></code> <code><dt></code> <code><dd></code>	Description list: term and its definition.

Tables

```

<table>
  <thead>
    <tr><th>Name</th><th>Score</th></tr>
  </thead>
  <tbody>
    <tr><td>Aisha</td><td>92</td></tr>
    <tr><td>Ravi</td><td>88</td></tr>
  </tbody>
</table>

```

HTML

Tag	Meaning
<code><table></code>	The table container.
<code><thead></code> / <code><tbody></code>	Groups the header row and the body rows.
<code><tr></code>	A table row.
<code><th></code>	A header cell (bold & centred by default).

Tag	Meaning
<code><td></code>	A normal data cell.
<code>colspan</code> / <code>rowspan</code>	Make a cell span several columns / rows.

Forms & inputs

HTML

```

<form action="/signup" method="post">
  <label for="email">Email</label>
  <input type="email" id="email" name="email" required>

  <label for="msg">Message</label>
  <textarea id="msg" name="msg"></textarea>

  <button type="submit">Send</button>
</form>

```

Element / type	Use
<code><label for></code>	Names a field; clicking it focuses that input.
<code><input></code>	A single-line field. The <code>type</code> decides its behaviour.
<code>type="text"</code>	Plain text.
<code>type="email"</code>	Email, with basic validation.
<code>type="password"</code>	Hidden characters.
<code>type="number"</code>	Numbers only, with steppers.
<code>type="checkbox" / "radio"</code>	Tick boxes / pick-one options.
<code><textarea></code>	Multi-line text.
<code><select> <option></code>	A drop-down menu.
<code><button></code>	A clickable button (<code>type="submit"</code> sends the form).
<code>required</code> / <code>placeholder</code>	Force a value / show hint text.

Semantic structure

Semantic tags describe the *role* of a region. They behave like `<div>` but make your page clearer to browsers, search engines, and screen readers.

Tag	Region it marks
<code><header></code>	Top of a page or section (logo, title).

Tag	Region it marks
<code><nav></code>	A set of navigation links.
<code><main></code>	The page's primary content (one per page).
<code><section></code>	A thematic grouping of content.
<code><article></code>	A self-contained piece (a post, a card).
<code><aside></code>	Side content (a sidebar, related links).
<code><footer></code>	Bottom of a page or section.
<code><div></code>	A generic box with no meaning — for grouping & styling.

Global attributes & entities

These attributes can go on almost any tag:

Attribute	Meaning
<code>id</code>	A unique name for one element (used by CSS & links).
<code>class</code>	A reusable label for styling many elements.
<code>style</code>	Inline CSS for a single element.
<code>title</code>	Tooltip text shown on hover.

Some characters must be written as **entities** so the browser doesn't treat them as code:

Entity	Shows
<code>&lt;</code> & <code>&gt;</code>	< and > (less-than, greater-than)
<code>&amp;</code>	& (ampersand)
<code>&copy;</code> & <code>&reg;</code>	© and ®
<code>&nbsp;</code>	A non-breaking space.

Pair this with the CSS Cheat Sheet

HTML builds the structure; CSS makes it look good. Keep both sheets open as you style your first pages in Day 1, then Day 3 goes deeper into layout with the box model, Flexbox and Grid.